

CrowdStrike Falcon Sensor for Windows

Release Notes — Version 7.18.0 — Published 2026-03-05

What's New in 7.18.0

Falcon Sensor 7.18.0 introduces kernel-mode telemetry improvements for credential access detection and reduces sensor CPU overhead by approximately 12% on supported platforms. This release also adds support for the updated Windows 11 24H2 kernel callback model.

Operating System Requirements

Operating System	Minimum Build	Falcon 7.18 Support
Windows 11 23H2	22631.0	Supported (legacy telemetry path)
Windows 11 24H2	26100.0	Required for full kernel callback feature set
Windows 11 25H2	27000.0	Supported
Windows 10 22H2	19045.0	Supported until EOL 2026-10-14

Important: The new kernel callback model used for credential access detection in this release **REQUIRES** Windows 11 24H2 (build 26100.0) or later. Sensors deployed to endpoints on Windows 11 23H2 or earlier will automatically fall back to the legacy telemetry path and will not receive the improved credential-theft detection coverage described in this release. This fallback is silent and does not generate an alert in the Falcon console by default.

Hardware & Firmware Prerequisites

No additional BIOS or firmware requirements are introduced directly by Falcon Sensor 7.18.0. However, administrators should be aware that Windows 11 24H2 itself enforces a minimum platform security baseline; refer to Microsoft and OEM documentation (e.g., Dell DCM-2026-Q1-117) for BIOS-level requirements associated with 24H2 deployment.

Deprecation Notice

Support for the legacy user-mode-only sensor architecture (used by Falcon Sensor versions 6.x and earlier) will be deprecated in an upcoming release. Customers still running 6.x sensors should plan migration to 7.x in the near term; an exact end-of-life build number has not yet been finalized and will be announced in a future bulletin.

Known Issues

ID	Description	Workaround
FAL-2026-0091	Sensor may report duplicate host records after in-place 23H2 -> 24H2 OS upgrade	Re-run host registration script post-upgrade
FAL-2026-0103	Elevated CPU usage during initial 24H2 kernel callback registration (first boot only)	None required; resolves after first boot